

AIF-C01: 14-Day Study Plan

PLAN B: 14-DAY STANDARD PLAN

Assumptions

- Your exam is 8 to 14 days away.
- You can commit roughly 90 minutes on weekdays and 3 hours on weekends.
- The goal is deeper review and active note-taking, not just exposure. This plan assumes a Monday start, with weekends falling on Days 6-7 and Days 13-14; if your week starts on a different day, simply shift the weekday/weekend labels to match your own calendar.

Plan B Schedule at a Glance

Day	Type	Theme	Time Budget	Key Materials	New / Review Flashcards	Practice Questions
1	Weekday (90 min)	Domain 1, Part 1: Basic AI Concepts and Terminology	60 min study / 20 min practice / 10 min review	Domain 1 Study Module, Task Statement 1.1	15 new / 0 review	4 (Domain 1 bank)
2	Weekday (90 min)	Domain 1, Part 2: Practical Use Cases	60 min study / 20 min practice / 10 min review	Domain 1 Study Module, Task Statement 1.2	15 new / 15 review	4 (Domain 1 bank)
3	Weekday (90 min)	Domain 2, Part 1: GenAI Fundamentals	60 min study / 20 min practice / 10 min review	Domain 2 Study Module, Task Statement 2.1	15 new / 20 review	4 (Domain 2 bank)
4	Weekday (90 min)	Domain 1 Wrap-Up: Lifecycle and MLOps	50 min study / 25 min practice / 15 min review	Domain 1 Study Module, Task Statement 1.3	15 new / 25 review	6 (remaining Domain 1 bank)
5	Weekday (90 min)	Domain 2, Part 2: Capabilities, Limitations, and AWS Infrastructure	60 min study / 20 min practice / 10 min review	Domain 2 Study Module, Task Statements 2.2 and 2.3	15 new / 25 review	8 (remaining Domain 2 bank)

Day	Type	Theme	Time Budget	Key Materials	New / Review Flashcards	Practice Questions
6	Weekend (3 hrs)	Domain 3, Part 1: Design Considerations and RAG	100 min study / 50 min practice / 30 min review	Domain 3 Study Module, Task Statement 3.1	20 new / 30 review	6 (Domain 3 bank)
7	Weekend (3 hrs)	Domain 3, Part 2: Prompt Engineering	100 min study / 50 min practice / 30 min review	Domain 3 Study Module, Task Statement 3.2	20 new / 30 review	6 (Domain 3 bank)
8	Weekday (90 min)	Domain 3, Part 3: Fine-Tuning and Training	60 min study / 20 min practice / 10 min review	Domain 3 Study Module, Task Statement 3.3	20 new / 35 review	5 (Domain 3 bank)
9	Weekday (90 min)	Domain 3, Part 4: Evaluating FM Performance	60 min study / 20 min practice / 10 min review	Domain 3 Study Module, Task Statement 3.4	20 new / 35 review	5 (remaining Domain 3 bank)
10	Weekday (90 min)	Domain 4: Responsible AI	60 min study / 20 min practice / 10 min review	Domain 4 Study Module (both task statements)	20 new / 40 review	7 (Domain 4 bank)
11	Weekday (90 min)	Domain 5: Security, Compliance, and Governance	60 min study / 20 min practice / 10 min review	Domain 5 Study Module (both task statements)	20 new / 40 review	7 (Domain 5 bank)
12	Weekday (90 min)	Service Dictionary and Glossary Review	50 min review / 30 min self-quiz / 10 min flashcards	AWS Services Quick Reference Guide; Master Glossary	0 new / 40 review	None today (active recall instead)

Day	Type	Theme	Time Budget	Key Materials	New / Review Flashcards	Practice Questions
13	Weekend (3 hrs)	Full Practice Exam	90 min exam / 60 min score review / 30 min light flashcard review	Full-Length Practice Exam (timed); Answer Key and Rationale Guide	0 new / 20 review	65 (the full exam)
14	Weekend (3 hrs, taper to light)	Flashcard Intensive and Cram Sheet First Read	90 min flashcards / 60 min Cheat Sheet read / remaining time rest	Master Flashcard Deck (full 175-card review); Visual Cheat Sheet	0 new / 175 review (full deck)	None

Note on Day 14: In the original recommended structure, Day 14 is also “Exam Day - light Cram Sheet review only, no new material, early rest.” If your actual exam date falls on what this table marks as Day 13 or 14, swap in your exam-day routine (see Plan A, Day 7) instead of the flashcard intensive, and push the flashcard/Cram Sheet work earlier. The schedule above assumes your exam is the day after Day 14.

Day-by-Day Checkpoints and Spaced Repetition

Day 1 checkpoint: I can define AI, ML, deep learning, neural networks, and inferencing in plain language.

Day 2 checkpoint: I can match classification, regression, and clustering to a one-sentence business example for each, and I know when AI/ML is the wrong solution for a problem.

Day 3 checkpoint: I can explain tokens, embeddings, and context windows using a non-technical analogy. *Spaced repetition callback:* Before starting today’s new material, spend 5 minutes re-explaining out loud (to yourself or someone else) the difference between supervised, unsupervised, and reinforcement learning from Day 1.

Day 4 checkpoint: I can describe the stages of the AI/ML development lifecycle and explain what MLOps means in plain terms. *Spaced repetition callback:* Revisit the classification-versus-regression-versus-clustering examples from Day 2 for 5 minutes before moving on.

Day 5 checkpoint: I can list three advantages and three disadvantages of GenAI, and I can name three AWS services used to build GenAI applications. *Spaced repetition callback:* Quickly re-quiz yourself on tokens, embeddings, and context windows from Day 3.

Day 6 checkpoint: I can explain RAG and name the four AWS vector-storage options for it (OpenSearch Service, Aurora, Neptune, RDS for PostgreSQL with pgvector). *Spaced repetition callback:* Spend 5 minutes restating the AI/ML lifecycle stages from Day 4.

Day 7 checkpoint: I can define and differentiate zero-shot, single-shot, few-shot, and chain-of-thought prompting, and I can name the four prompt-related security risks (exposure, poisoning, hijacking, jailbreaking). *Spaced repetition callback:* Re-explain GenAI's advantages and disadvantages from Day 5.

Day 8 checkpoint: I can describe the difference between fine-tuning, instruction tuning, transfer learning, and continuous pre-training, and I know what RLHF stands for and does. *Spaced repetition callback:* Restate the RAG definition and vector-database list from Day 6.

Day 9 checkpoint: I can name the evaluation metrics used for FM performance (ROUGE, BLEU, BERTScore, LLM-as-a-judge) and say which is used for what. *Spaced repetition callback:* Re-quiz the four prompt-engineering techniques from Day 7.

Day 10 checkpoint: I can name the six responsible AI features and connect Amazon SageMaker Clarify, SageMaker Model Monitor, and Amazon A2I to the problems they solve. *Spaced repetition callback:* Restate the fine-tuning methods from Day 8.

Day 11 checkpoint: I can explain the AWS Shared Responsibility Model in the context of AI workloads and distinguish CloudTrail, CloudWatch, and Config. *Spaced repetition callback:* Re-quiz the evaluation metrics from Day 9.

Day 12 checkpoint: I can state the primary purpose of every in-scope AWS service from memory and clearly differentiate the most commonly confused pairs (Bedrock vs. SageMaker AI, Macie vs. Inspector, CloudTrail vs. CloudWatch, Artifact vs. Audit Manager). *Spaced repetition callback:* This entire day is built around reviewing everything from Days 1-11, so no single callback is needed; treat the whole session as cumulative review.

Day 13 checkpoint: I know my overall practice score and my single weakest domain, with specific topics identified for re-study.

Day 14 checkpoint: I can recall, without looking, at least one fact from every row of the Visual Cheat Sheet.
